P PETERHOUSE PRESCHOOL

SYSTEM SPECIFICATION · OCTOBER 2026

Peterhouse Learning Review

A simpler way for teachers to complete June and December portfolios, and a warmer, more beautiful report for every family.

IN THIS DOCUMENT

80+
features, each marked Must, Should or Could

7
Cambridge Early Years areas, 21 skills

0
children's names, photos or birthdays sent to an AI service

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At a glance

~100
children across the school

200
reports a year (June and December)

~30
taps to complete one child's review

<10
minutes per child, our target including checking

HOW TO READ THE PRIORITIES

- **MUST** needed for the demo and the first live version
- **SHOULD** strongly recommended for the first live version
- **COULD** valuable later, once the basics are working
- **LATER** out of scope for now, listed so it is not forgotten

> **About this draft.** This is a feature specification, not a quote or a timeline. It describes what the system should do and why, so the school can agree the scope before a working demo is shown. Sections marked as recommendations are open for discussion; section 14 lists the decisions we need from the school.

01

The idea in one page

Teachers spend long evenings typing June and December reports, one child at a time. The Learning Review replaces that typing with a short structured review. The system writes a warm first draft. The teacher checks it, edits it and approves it. Families receive a beautiful Peterhouse report.

FOR TEACHERS

Tap, don't type

Pick the sentence that sounds most like the child, tick what you saw, add one highlight. The draft is written for you, and you always have the final word.

FOR FAMILIES

A report worth keeping

A personal, specific portfolio with the child's photo, clear progress in each area, and simple ideas for supporting learning at home. Words, never scores.

FOR THE SCHOOL

Consistent and on time

Every report follows the same Cambridge Early Years structure and house style. Leaders can see at a glance which classes are finished.

Five principles

When two ideas conflict, the principle higher on the list wins.

#	PRINCIPLE	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
1	**Children's identity never leaves the school**	Names, surnames, birthdays and photos stay on the school computer. Only anonymous answers are ever sent for writing help (section 06).
2	**The teacher has the final word**	Nothing reaches a family until the teacher has read, edited if needed, and approved it.
3	**Words, not scores, for families**	No numbers, averages or comparisons with other children ever appear in a report.
4	**Fewer taps beat more fields**	Every question must earn its place. Sensible defaults mean teachers only change what stands out.
5	**Simple to run**	One school, one computer, one folder of data that is easy to back up.

What is in and out of scope is set out with the roadmap in section 13.

02

Who uses the system

Three kinds of staff sign in. Families do not sign in in this version; they receive the finished report from the school.

ROLE	USUALLY	CAN	CANNOT
Administrator	Principal or office manager	Open and close terms; create classes and children; add staff and assign them to classes; edit the wording of skills and descriptors; see and download every report; run backups; reopen any approved report.	—
Lead teacher	One per class	Everything a co-teacher can, plus: generate and edit the written draft, approve reports, reopen their own class's reports, download class reports.	See other classes. Change the rubric.
Co-teacher	Assistant or second teacher in the class	Open any child in their class; set skill levels, tick what they saw, add notes and the highlight; upload photos.	Approve reports. See other classes.
Family	Parents and guardians	Receive the approved PDF, printed or sent by the school.	Sign in (not in this version).

Recommendation: how co-teachers work together

Many classes have more than one adult. Without a clear rule, teachers can overwrite each other's work. We recommend:

One review per child, shared by the class team

There is exactly one review per child per term. Everyone assigned to the class works on the same review, so observations from all adults end up in one place.

The lead teacher owns approval

Only the lead teacher (or the administrator) approves. This gives every report one accountable person, which matches "teacher approval is enough".

Save each area separately

Changes save per area, not per form. If two people edit different areas at the same time, nothing is lost. Each area shows "Last changed by Ms Tan, 2:14 pm".

Show who is editing

If someone else has the same area open, a gentle notice appears: "Ms Lim is editing Literacy". The second person can still read but is asked before overwriting.

The report names the lead teacher first, then co-teachers. COULD Specialist teachers add their own note.

03

How a term runs, end to end

Every term follows the same six steps. Red steps are done by people; the gold step is done by the system.

1
Prepare the term
ADMINISTRATOR
Open “December 2026”, roll classes forward, add new children, check photos and consent.

2
Observe and rate
CLASS TEAM
For each child, pick descriptors, tick what you saw, add a highlight. Saves as you go.

3
Write the draft
SYSTEM
Turns anonymous answers into an opening, a paragraph per area and a closing.

4
Edit and approve
LEAD TEACHER
Read the preview, fix anything, approve. Approved reports are locked.

5
Produce reports
TEACHER OR ADMIN
Download one PDF or a zip of the whole class. Print or pass to families.

6
Close the term
ADMINISTRATOR
Lock the term, keep it as history, back up the data folder.

A suggested six-week rhythm

The system does not enforce dates, but leaders can set a target date per step and see who is behind.

WEEK	FOCUS	WHAT HAPPENS
Week 1	Set-up	Admin opens the term, imports any new children, assigns teachers, uploads term photos.
Weeks 2–4	Rating	Class teams complete reviews alongside normal observation. Home screen shows “11 of 18 ready”.
Week 5	Drafts and approval	Lead teachers generate drafts (one child or the whole class), read, edit and approve.
Week 6	Produce and close	Class zips downloaded and printed; admin locks the term and backs up.

One child’s review, step by step

1. Open the class and pick a child. Every skill starts at **Growing**.
2. In each area, change only the skills that stand out, tick what you saw, and add a short note if useful.
3. Answer the highlight: “What did this child love this term?” The review becomes **Ready**.
4. The lead teacher presses **Write draft**; the paragraphs appear in seconds, each editable, with anything to check highlighted.
5. Preview the real PDF and press **Approve**. The report is locked and ready to download.

04

Designing the questions

The question design decides whether teachers love or resent the system. The goal: a fair, specific picture of each child in the fewest possible decisions.

The problem with the first draft

The original brief asked, for each of seven areas, three 1–5 ratings plus two multiple-choice questions. That is **35 decisions per child**, or 3,500 across the school each term. Two issues stood out:

- **Overlap.** The choice questions ("needs a prompt" to "does this independently") mostly repeat what the rating already says, so teachers answer the same thing twice.
- **Numbers mean different things to different people.** One teacher's "3" is another's "4". Bare numbers lead to inconsistent reports.

Recommendation: describe, don't score

CHANGE 1

Pick the sentence, not the number

Each skill shows five short descriptions of what a child does at each level. The teacher picks the one that sounds most like the child. The number is stored behind the scenes but never shown on the form.

CHANGE 2

Swap 14 choice questions for 7 tick rows

Each area gets one optional "What did you see?" row of moments (Circle time, Outdoor play, With a friend…). One to three taps give the writing concrete, true detail without any typing.

CHANGE 3

Add "Not yet observed"

For a child who joined late or was away, a teacher should never be forced to guess. The report then says, gently, that the team is still getting to know the child in that area.

CHANGE 4

Start from what you already know

Everything starts at Growing. From the second term, a **Copy from June** button pre-fills last term's levels, clearly marked so the teacher confirms each one.

What the teacher sees for one skill

Communication and Language · Listens and responds. The selected level is outlined in red.

Beginning	Developing	Growing	Confident	Flourishing
Is starting to turn towards a familiar voice and listen for short moments.	Listens in a small group and responds when an adult helps them focus.	Listens to stories and simple instructions and usually responds.	Listens closely at group time and answers questions about what they heard.	Listens with care, asks follow-up questions and builds on others' ideas.

What did you see? (optional, pick up to three)

Circle time · Story corner · Role play · Outdoor play · With a friend · With a teacher · Show and tell · Not yet observed

Before and after

	FIRST DRAFT	RECOMMENDED
Decisions per child	35 (21 ratings + 14 choices)	21 ratings, most left at the default, plus up to 7 optional tick rows
What a level means	A bare number, interpreted by each teacher	A described behaviour everyone reads the same way
Concrete detail for the writing	Generic choice wording	Real moments the teacher saw
New or absent children	Forced to guess	"Not yet observed"
Typing	One highlight	One highlight, plus an optional short note per area (up to 140 characters)
Second term	Start from scratch	Copy from last term, then confirm

Age groups. In the first version every child uses the same form, as the brief asked. Descriptors are written to describe what the child does, not what is "expected for their age", so they work across Nursery to K2. A separate set of descriptors for each age group is listed as a `COULD`, because a two-year-old and a six-year-old will eventually deserve different wording.

05

What the system calculates

The system does do some calculation, but its job is to choose the right words and spot patterns, not to give a child a mark. Here is every calculation, and who sees the result.

CALCULATION	HOW IT WORKS	WHO SEES IT
Skill level	The descriptor the teacher picked, stored as 1 to 5. Shown as five square marks plus the word, for example ■■■■□ Confident.	Teachers and families (marks and word only)
Area summary	The middle of the three skill levels (the median). Using the middle rather than the average means one unusual rating cannot drag the whole area up or down. Skills marked “Not yet observed” are left out; with fewer than two observed skills there is no summary.	Feeds the writing; shown to families as a word in the area heading
Progress since last term	Each skill is compared with the last approved review. Moved up → a small “↑ since June” note. Same → nothing shown. Moved down → never shown to families; flagged privately to the teacher to double-check.	Families see “moved up” only; teachers see all three
Strengths and next steps	The system suggests the two highest skills as strengths and one or two of the lowest as next steps. The teacher can swap them with a tap. These drive the closing “Looking ahead” panel.	Teachers choose; families see the result in words
Class overview	A grid of every child × seven areas, coloured by level, so leaders can spot a child who may need extra support or an area the whole class finds hard.	Lead teacher and administrator only
Completion	Counts of not started, draft, ready and approved per class and teacher.	Teachers (their classes) and administrator

What families never see

- ☐ Any number, score, percentage or average
- ☐ Rankings, or comparisons with other children or the class
- ☐ A skill that moved down since last term
- ☐ Labels such as “behind”, “delayed” or any diagnosis

Why moved-down is private. Young children’s development is uneven, and a lower level is often a different teacher’s reading or a hard week. Showing a drop on paper can alarm families without context. The system asks the teacher to confirm instead, and if there is a real concern, it should be discussed with the family in person rather than through the report.

06

Writing with AI, privately

The school has been clear: children's information must not leak. The system is designed so that the writing service never learns who the child is. It sees anonymous answers, writes about "[Child]", and the name is put back in on the school computer.

What leaves the school computer, and what never does

SENT FOR WRITING (ANONYMOUS)

- The placeholder "[Child]" instead of any name
- Pronoun chosen by the teacher (she, he or they)
- The term, for example "December"
- Skill names and the level word (Confident)
- The "what did you see?" ticks
- Notes and the highlight, after name-scrubbing
- Which skills are strengths and next steps

NEVER SENT

- ☐ Preferred name, legal name or surname
- ☐ Date of birth or exact age
- ☐ Photo, or where it is stored
- ☐ Class name, teacher names or school name
- ☐ Names of other children or family members
- ☐ Any private staff note
- ☐ Anything from another child's review

Example of exactly what is sent

```
pronoun: she            term: December
highlight: "Loved building a boat for [Child]'s toy animals in the block area"
Communication and Language
  Listens and responds ............. Confident   (seen at: Circle time, Role play)
  Speaks with friends and teachers .. Growing
  Uses new words from stories ....... Confident   note: "Used 'enormous' all week"
strengths: Listens and responds; Experiments with materials
next steps: Names feelings and asks for help
```

Before sending, a local check replaces any name found in the school roster (children, siblings, staff) with "[Child]" or "[Friend]", and blocks phone numbers and emails. Teachers see a quiet reminder beside every text box: "Please don't include names or health details." A **"What was sent?"** button shows this exact text to any teacher who asks.

Three ways to write, for the school to choose

OPTION	HOW IT WORKS	TRADE-OFFS
A · Anonymous cloud AI RECOMMENDED	Anonymous answers go to a paid business AI service (Google Gemini or OpenAI) whose terms state inputs are not used to train its models. The service never receives identifying information.	Best writing quality. Needs internet. Small running cost per report. Terms to be re-checked before go-live.

B · AI on the school computer	A smaller AI model runs on the school's own computer. Nothing leaves the building at all.	Needs a capable computer (for example a recent Mac with 16 GB memory or more). Slower, and writing is a step less polished.
C · Sentence bank, no AI	Each descriptor has two or three pre-written sentences in the school's voice. The system assembles paragraphs from them; the teacher polishes.	Fully offline and predictable. Reads more repetitive across a class.

Recommendation: Option A as the main route, with Option C built in as the automatic fallback when the internet is down or the AI service fails. Option B can be added later if the school prefers that no text leaves the building at all. The demo will show A and C side by side.

Writing rules the system enforces

Every draft is told to

- Write for parents: warm, plain, specific, British spelling (Programme, colour)
- Say only what the answers support, never invent an event
- Use gentle language for Beginning and Developing ("is beginning to…", "with a little support…")
- Keep to length: opening 60–80 words, each area 40–60 words, closing 50–70 words
- End with one or two ideas families can try at home

After writing, the system checks for

- Any number or score that slipped in
- Words on a "never use" list (behind, delayed, poor, fails, diagnosis terms)
- Comparisons with other children
- Paragraphs that are too long or too short
- A skill mentioned that was "not yet observed"
- A missing or broken response (tries once more, then uses the sentence bank)

Anything flagged is highlighted in gold for the teacher to look at. The teacher can always edit any paragraph, rewrite just one paragraph, or rewrite the whole draft (after a confirmation, with the previous version kept).

07

Full feature catalogue

Every feature, grouped into eleven areas of the system. Each is marked Must, Should, Could or Later (see page 1).

7.1 Signing in and access

Keeps each class's information visible only to the right people, including on shared staffroom computers.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Email and password sign-in	Each staff member has their own account. Passwords are stored scrambled, never readable.	MUST
Three roles	Administrator, lead teacher and co-teacher, as described in section 02.	MUST
Class-based access	Teachers only ever see children in classes they are assigned to, including in search and downloads.	MUST
Automatic sign-out	Signs out after 30 minutes without activity, for shared computers.	MUST
Password reset by admin	Admin sets a temporary password; the teacher must change it at next sign-in.	MUST
Deactivate departing staff	Blocks sign-in but keeps their name on past reports.	MUST
Lock after failed attempts	Pauses an account after five wrong passwords in a row.	SHOULD
Two-step sign-in for admin	A code from a phone app as well as the password for the administrator account.	COULD

7.2 School set-up

Done by the administrator, mostly once a term.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Terms	June or December plus a year. Open, close and lock. Only one term open for writing at a time.	MUST
Classes	Name (for example K1 Sunflower), level (Nursery, K1, K2), lead teacher and co-teachers.	MUST
Children	Preferred name, legal name, date of birth, pronoun, class, photo consent, status (active or left).	MUST
Mark a child as left	Hides them from lists but keeps their past reports.	MUST

Import from a spreadsheet	Upload an Excel or CSV list of children. Shows a preview with any errors (missing birthday, unknown class) before saving.	SHOULD
Roll forward to a new term	Copies classes and teams into the new term and moves children up a level in one step, with a review screen.	SHOULD
Move a child mid-term	The child's review moves with them; the new class team takes over.	SHOULD
School details	Name, address, phone and email used in the report footer, editable in one place.	SHOULD

7.3 Child profile and photo

The photo makes the report personal; it is also the most sensitive item, so it never leaves the school computer.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Square cover photo	Upload, crop to a square, shrink to a sensible size, and remove hidden location and camera data.	MUST
Photo consent	If a family has not consented, the report uses a Peterhouse pattern tile with the child's initial instead.	MUST
A photo for each term	Each term keeps its own photo, so past reports still show the child as they were.	SHOULD
Bulk photo upload	Drop in a folder of photos; the system matches them to children by file name and asks about any it cannot match.	COULD
Child history	One page per child with every past term's report and levels over time.	SHOULD

7.4 The review form

Where teachers spend most of their time. Built for speed on a desktop or laptop.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Area-by-area steps	Seven areas in a side list with progress ("4 of 7 visited"), plus the highlight and photo.	MUST
Descriptor buttons	Five described levels per skill, starting at Growing, plus "Not yet observed".	MUST
"What did you see?" ticks	Up to three moments per area, editable by the admin.	MUST
Highlight question	"What did this child love this term?" One or two sentences.	MUST
Autosave	Saves every change instantly per area, with a visible "Saved" marker. Nothing is lost if the browser closes.	MUST

Next child	Moves straight to the next child in the class who is not yet ready.	MUST
Readiness check	Lists anything missing before a draft can be written.	MUST
Privacy reminder	A quiet line next to every text box: no names or health details.	MUST
Optional note per area	Up to 140 characters for a concrete moment (“Counted 12 shells at the beach table”).	SHOULD
Copy from last term	Pre-fills levels from the last approved review, each marked “from June” until confirmed.	SHOULD
Keyboard shortcuts	Keys 1–5 pick a level, arrow keys move between skills, so a fast typist never touches the mouse.	SHOULD
Private staff note	A note for colleagues that is never printed and never sent for writing.	SHOULD
Who changed what	Each area shows the last person to change it and when.	SHOULD

7.5 Draft writing and editing

Turns the answers into prose the teacher is happy to sign.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Write the draft	Produces an opening, one paragraph per area and a “Looking ahead” closing from anonymous answers.	MUST
Name put back locally	“[Child]” is replaced with the preferred name on the school computer after writing.	MUST
Edit each paragraph	Plain text editing with British English spell check and a word count.	MUST
Rewrite with confirmation	Rewriting the whole draft asks first and keeps the previous version.	MUST
Name-scrubbing	Replaces roster names in notes before sending; blocks phone numbers and emails.	MUST
“What was sent?” view	Shows the exact anonymous text sent for writing.	SHOULD
Rewrite one paragraph	Rewrites just one area without touching the teacher’s edits elsewhere.	SHOULD
Automatic quality checks	Highlights numbers, “never use” words, length problems (see section 06).	SHOULD
Sentence-bank fallback	Assembles a draft from pre-written sentences when AI is unavailable.	SHOULD

Whole-class drafts	Writes drafts for every ready child in a class in one go, with a progress bar.	SHOULD
Choice of AI service	Admin can switch between Gemini, OpenAI, local AI or sentence bank in settings.	SHOULD
Tone buttons	“Shorter”, “Warmer”, “Simpler” for a single paragraph.	COULD
Version history	See and restore any earlier version of a draft.	COULD
AI on the school computer	Option B in section 06, for zero external processing.	COULD

7.6 Approval

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Preview before approving	Shows the real PDF, marked DRAFT, exactly as the family will see it.	MUST
Approve and lock	Lead teacher approves; the report can no longer be changed.	MUST
Reopen with a reason	Lead teacher or admin reopens an approved report, giving a reason that is logged.	MUST
Report version number	Reopened and re-approved reports show “v2” in the footer so printed copies can be told apart.	SHOULD
Optional principal check	A switchable second approval step, off by default.	COULD

7.7 The report PDF

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Branded A4 report	About six pages in Peterhouse colours and type (section 09), from the approved text only.	MUST
Download one report	For any approved review.	MUST
Download a whole class	A zip of every approved report in the class.	MUST
Clear file names	For example *2026-12_K1-Sunflower_Mia.pdf*, sorted alphabetically.	MUST
DRAFT watermark	On every preview that is not approved.	MUST
Print-ready layout	Colours and margins that print well on an office printer; page breaks never split a skill.	SHOULD
One combined print file	A single PDF of the whole class for one print job.	COULD

Password-protected PDFs	Each PDF opens with, for example, the child's birth date, for safer emailing by the office.	COULD

7.8 Home screens and overviews

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Teacher home	Open term, my classes, "14 of 18 approved", and a button to continue the next unfinished child.	MUST
Class list	Each child with photo, status and last change.	MUST
School progress (admin)	Completion by class and teacher against the target dates.	SHOULD
Class overview grid	Children × areas, coloured by level, for planning support (internal only).	SHOULD
Export levels to Excel	A spreadsheet of the term's levels for school records or inspection.	COULD

7.9 Rubric management

Lets the school own its wording without asking a developer.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Edit wording	Admin edits skill names, descriptors and "what did you see?" ticks.	MUST
Frozen copy per review	A review keeps the wording it started with, so later edits never change reports in progress or past reports.	MUST
Sentence bank editor	Edit the pre-written sentences used by the fallback.	SHOULD
Descriptors by age group	Separate wording for Nursery, K1 and K2.	COULD
Add or remove areas and skills	Change the structure, not just the words.	COULD

7.10 Data protection and records

This is children's personal data under Singapore's Personal Data Protection Act (PDPA). These features protect the children and the school.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Data stays on the school computer	All records and photos live in one data folder on the school's machine.	MUST
Anonymous writing only	Section 06 rules, enforced in the code and checked by automated tests.	MUST

Secure sessions	Sign-in cookies cannot be read by other scripts; all pages need sign-in.	MUST
Automatic backups	A daily copy of the data folder to a second place (for example an external drive), keeping the last 30 days, with a simple restore.	SHOULD
Activity log	Who viewed, changed, approved, reopened or downloaded each report, and when.	SHOULD
Retention rule	After a set period (the school decides, for example three years after leaving), records and photos are removed, with a reminder before.	SHOULD
Encrypted storage	The data folder sits on an encrypted disk so a stolen computer reveals nothing.	SHOULD
Family data request	Export everything held about one child, for a parent's access request.	COULD

7.11 Families (future)

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	PRIORITY
Email reports to families	Send each approved report to the contacts on file, with a delivery log.	COULD
Parent acknowledgement	Families confirm they received and read the report.	LATER
Parent portal	Families sign in to see all their child's reports over the years.	LATER
Other languages	Reports in Chinese or other languages.	LATER

UNDER THE HOOD, BRIEFLY

A web application that runs on one school computer and is opened in a normal browser on any staff computer in the school. Records are kept in a single database file plus a photos folder, so backing up means copying one folder. PDFs are produced by printing the report page in a built-in browser, so the report uses the real Peterhouse fonts and colours. The AI service can be changed in settings without changing the system.

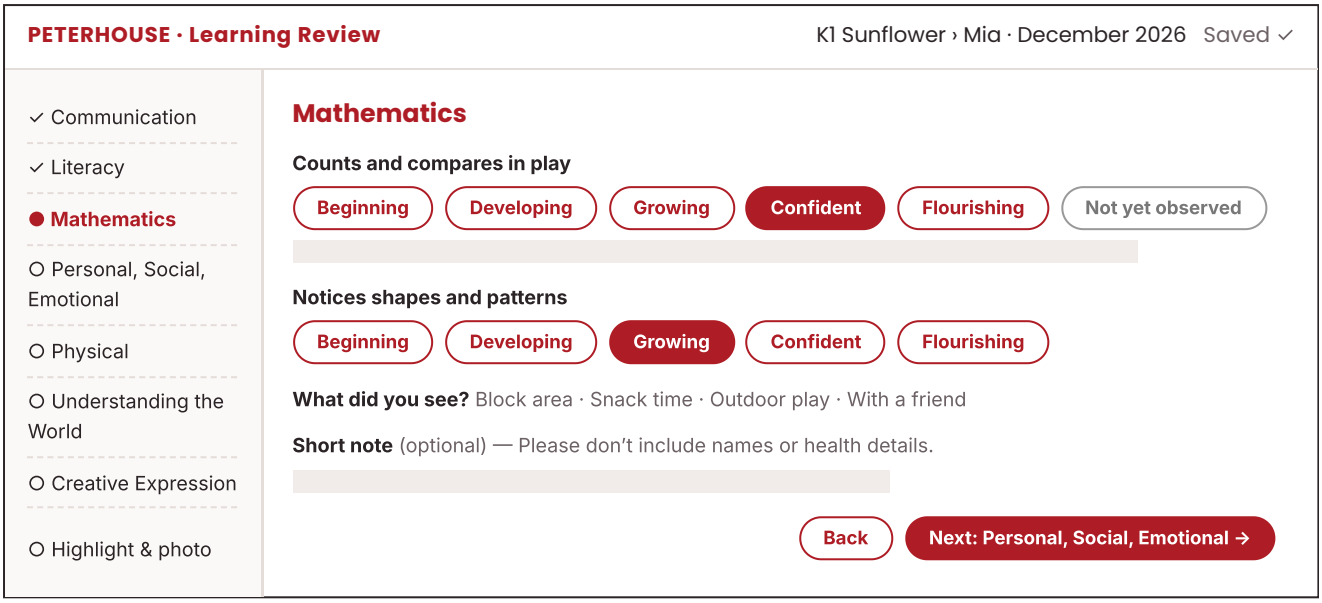
08

Screens

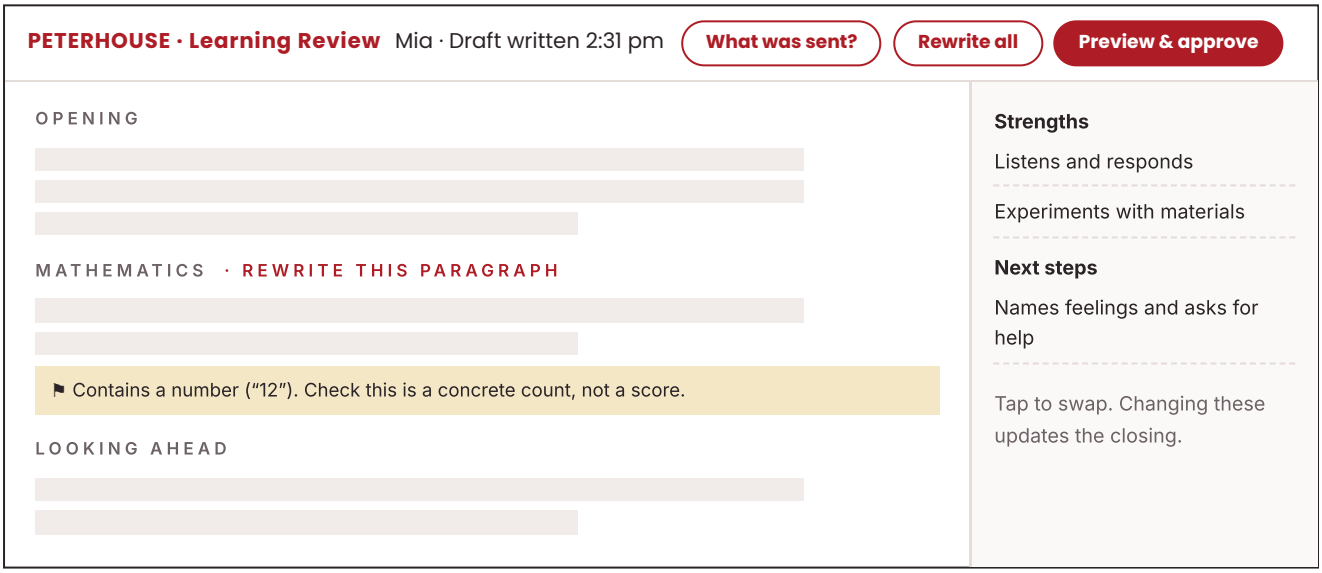
Nine screens, all in Peterhouse style: white pages, red Poppins headings, pill buttons, square corners and no shadows. Designed for a desktop or laptop browser.

#	SCREEN	WHO	WHAT IT SHOWS
1	**Sign in**	Everyone	Crest, email, password, “Forgotten password? Ask your administrator.”
2	**Teacher home**	Teachers	Open term, each class with “14 of 18 approved”, a Continue button for the next unfinished child.
3	**Class**	Teachers	Children with photo, status, last change; filter by status; download class zip.
4	**Review form**	Teachers	Area steps, descriptor buttons, “what did you see?” ticks, notes, highlight, photo, saved marker.
5	**Draft and approve**	Lead teacher	Write draft, editable paragraphs with gold flags, strengths and next steps, PDF preview, Approve.
6	**Child history**	Teachers, admin	Every past report and levels over time.
7	**School progress**	Admin	Completion by class and teacher; class overview grids.
8	**Set-up**	Admin	Terms, classes, staff, children, import, roll forward, school details.
9	**Settings**	Admin	Rubric wording, sentence bank, AI choice, backups, retention, activity log.

Sketch: the review form



Sketch: draft and approve



09

The report families receive

A new A4 print layout built from the school's website design: red, gold, sky and blush blocks, square corners, Poppins headings, and a warm, concrete voice. About six pages.

PAGE	CONTENT
1 · Cover	Crest on white; kicker "DECEMBER 2026"; heading "Learning Review"; preferred name, class and age (years and months, calculated from date of birth); square photo (no shadow, no rounded corners); the opening paragraph. Red slab, gold band, sky and blush blocks as on the website cover.
2–5 · Areas	Roughly two areas per page. Each has a spaced kicker ("AREA 3 OF 7"), the area name in red Poppins with the summary word, three skills each with five square marks and the level word, a small "↑ since June" where a skill moved up, and one paragraph.
6 · Looking ahead	Blush panel with the closing paragraph, "Shining this term" (two strengths) and "Next steps" (one or two), plus two simple ideas to try at home. Lead teacher and co-teachers, class name, and the footer +65 8028 9094 | admin@peterhouse.sg.

How one area looks

AREA 3 OF 7 · CAMBRIDGE EARLY YEARS

Mathematics · Confident overall

Counts and compares in play	■■■■□	Confident ↑ since June
Notices shapes and patterns	■■■□□	Growing
Uses number talk in the day	■■■■□	Confident

Mia has loved counting this term, especially at snack time, where she makes sure every friend has the same number of crackers. In the block area she sorts shapes by size and is beginning to spot simple repeating patterns. She now uses words like "more", "fewer" and "the same" with growing confidence during play.

Illustrative example using a fictional child.

Design rules

- **Sky** marks the Cambridge programme.
- **Blush** is used only for the closing panel.
- **Gold** is decoration only, never text on white.
- **Red** is for headings and the filled marks.
- Body text at least 10.5 pt for easy reading.
- Levels are always shown as marks and a word, never colour alone.
- No page break splits a skill or a paragraph.
- British spelling throughout (Programme, colour).

10

Statuses and rules

Each child has exactly one review per term. A review moves through five statuses.

STATUS	MEANING	MOVES ON WHEN
Not started	The child is in the class for this term, but nobody has opened the review.	Someone opens it
Draft	Answers are being filled in. The wording is frozen at this moment.	Every area visited, highlight answered, photo or no-photo set
Ready	All answers are complete. A draft can now be written.	Lead teacher writes the draft
Written	The draft exists and is being checked and edited.	Lead teacher approves
Approved	Locked. The PDF can be downloaded.	Reopened with a reason → back to Written

Rules

1. One review per child per term. A child who changes class keeps the same review.
2. The rubric wording is copied onto a review when it is first opened. Later edits to the wording affect new reviews only.
3. Changing an answer after the draft is written marks the affected paragraph “answers changed since writing”, but never rewrites it automatically.
4. Rewriting the whole draft always asks first and keeps the previous version.
5. The PDF always uses the teacher’s edited text, never the original AI wording.
6. Only approved reviews can be downloaded without a DRAFT watermark.
7. Reopening requires a reason and is recorded in the activity log.
8. When a term is locked, nothing in it can change unless the administrator unlocks it.

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Unusual situations

SITUATION	WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES
Child joined late in the term	Teachers mark skills “Not yet observed”; the opening acknowledges the child is settling in and the team is getting to know them.
Long absence	Same as above, without mentioning the reason.
No photo consent	A Peterhouse pattern tile with the child’s initial replaces the photo.

Two children with the same name	Staff screens add the surname initial (“Mia T.”, “Mia L.”). The report uses the preferred name only.
Siblings in the same class	The name-scrubber replaces both names, so one child’s report cannot mention the other by name to the AI service.
Teacher leaves mid-term	Admin reassigns the class; all drafts stay; the leaving teacher can no longer sign in.
Child leaves mid-term	Marked as left; review stays in history; no report needed unless the school wants one.
Internet or AI service down	Sentence-bank draft is offered instead; ratings are never lost.
Mistake found after printing	Reopen with a reason, fix, re-approve; the new PDF shows “v2”.
Serious concern about a child	The report is not the place for it. A private staff note and a reminder to talk with the family in person.
Two teachers edit the same child	Per-area saving and an “is editing” notice (section 02).

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The demo

Before any live use, the school will see a working demo. It uses only fictional children and illustrated placeholder photos, so no real child's information is involved.

What the demo includes

- One administrator, one lead teacher and one co-teacher account
- One class of eight fictional children
- The full review form with descriptors, ticks and highlight
- Drafts written by anonymous cloud AI and by the sentence bank, side by side
- The "What was sent?" view, to show nothing identifying leaves
- Editing, approval and the branded PDF
- A class zip download

What we want to learn from the school

- Does the descriptor wording sound like Peterhouse?
- Can a teacher finish one child in under ten minutes?
- Are the drafts close enough that teachers only make small edits?
- Is the report something families will treasure?
- Which Should features matter most to the school?

A good demo means

A teacher who has never seen the system completes one child's review, writes and approves the draft, and downloads the PDF without help, and the principal is comfortable with what is sent to the AI service.

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Roadmap

PHASE	WHAT IT ADDS
1 · Demo	Every MUST feature, with fictional data, for the school to try.
2 · First live version	Changes from demo feedback, plus the SHOULD features: spreadsheet import, roll forward, backups, activity log, quality checks, whole-class drafts, sentence-bank fallback, progress since last term.
3 · After the first live term	Chosen COULD features: age-group descriptors, emailing families, tone buttons, version history, specialist teacher notes, AI on the school computer.
4 · Later	Parent portal, parent acknowledgement, other languages.

Scope of the first live version

In scope

- Staff accounts with admin, lead teacher and co-teacher roles
- Terms, classes, children and photos
- The review form, the written draft, editing and approval
- The branded A4 report as a PDF, one at a time or a whole class
- Progress compared with the previous term
- Backups, an activity log and data retention

Out of scope for now

- ☐ Parent logins and a parent portal
- ☐ Emailing reports to families from the system
- ☐ Attendance, fees and enrolment
- ☐ Separate enrichment or specialist reports
- ☐ Languages other than English

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Decisions for the school

These choices are the school's to make. A recommendation is given for each, so a quick "yes, go with that" is enough.

#	QUESTION	RECOMMENDATION
1	Which writing option: anonymous cloud AI, AI on the school computer, or sentence bank only?	Anonymous cloud AI, with sentence bank as fallback
2	Should families be told that anonymous answers are used to help draft reports, for example in the enrolment privacy notice?	Yes, one plain sentence; transparency builds trust
3	Is the descriptor approach (section 04) right, and who at the school will review the wording?	Yes; one senior teacher reviews all 105 descriptors before the demo
4	Should co-teachers be able to approve, or only lead teachers?	Lead teachers only
5	Should "↑ since June" appear on reports?	Yes, moved-up only
6	How long should records be kept after a child leaves?	School to confirm, for example three years
7	Which computer will run the system, and who looks after backups?	To be decided before go-live
8	Do all families consent to a photo on the report?	Record consent per child; placeholder tile otherwise
9	Who is the administrator account holder?	Principal, with the office manager as a second admin
10	Should reports include ideas to try at home?	Yes, two short ideas in the closing panel

Next step. Once the school has looked at this document and answered the questions above, the working demo will be prepared with fictional children so teachers and leaders can try the full journey for themselves.

APPENDIX A

Skills and descriptors

Seven Cambridge Early Years areas, three skills each. All wording is stored in the system and can be changed by the administrator.

AREA	SKILLS
Communication and Language	Listens and responds · Speaks with friends and teachers · Uses new words from stories and play
Literacy	Enjoys books and stories · Notices letters and sounds in play · Makes marks and early writing
Mathematics	Counts and compares in play · Notices shapes and patterns · Uses number talk in the day
Personal, Social and Emotional Development	Settles into the group · Shares, takes turns, and cares for friends · Names feelings and asks for help
Physical Development	Moves with control indoors and out · Uses hands for making and self-care · Joins active play with balance
Understanding the World	Asks about people, places, and nature · Explores how things work · Talks about family and the day
Creative Expression	Joins songs, movement, and pretend play · Experiments with materials · Shows ideas through making

The five levels

LEVEL	MARKS	GENERAL MEANING (EACH SKILL HAS ITS OWN SENTENCE)
Beginning	■□□□□	Is starting to show this, in short moments or with lots of support.
Developing	■■□□□	Shows this sometimes, usually when an adult helps.
Growing	■■■□□	Shows this regularly in familiar situations.
Confident	■■■■□	Shows this easily and independently in different situations.
Flourishing	■■■■■	Shows this independently and takes it further, helping or inspiring others.

Example: full descriptors for Communication and Language

SKILL	BEGINNING	DEVELOPING	GROWING	CONFIDENT	FLOURISHING
Listens and responds	Turns towards a familiar voice and listens for short moments.	Listens in a small group and responds when helped to focus.	Listens to stories and simple instructions and usually responds.	Listens closely at group time and answers questions about it.	Asks follow-up questions and builds on others' ideas.
Speaks with friends and teachers	Uses gestures, sounds or single words to share needs.	Uses short phrases with familiar adults and friends.	Talks in simple sentences about what they are doing.	Chats in longer sentences and takes turns in conversation.	Starts conversations, explains ideas and tells their own stories.
Uses new words from stories and play	Is beginning to repeat words they hear often.	Uses some new words when an adult models them.	Tries out new words from stories in play.	Uses new words correctly in different situations.	Asks what new words mean and uses them playfully.

The remaining 18 skills follow the same pattern: one observable behaviour per level, in the school's warm, concrete voice. They will be drafted for the school's review before the demo.

"What did you see?" moments (starting set)

Circle time · Story corner · Role play · Block area · Art table · Outdoor play · Snack and lunch time · Music and movement · With a friend · In a small group · On their own · With a teacher · Show and tell · Tidy-up time

Each area shows the eight most relevant moments; the administrator can edit the list.

APPENDIX B

Glossary

Area	One of the seven Cambridge Early Years learning areas, such as Mathematics.
Skill	One of three things observed within an area, such as “Counts and compares in play”.
Descriptor	The one-sentence description of what a child does at a given level of a skill.
Level	Beginning, Developing, Growing, Confident or Flourishing.
Review	Everything recorded about one child in one term: levels, ticks, notes, highlight, photo and written report.
Rubric	The full set of areas, skills, descriptors and ticks the school uses.
Draft	The written report produced from the answers, before the teacher approves it.
Sentence bank	Pre-written sentences linked to each descriptor, used when AI is not available or not chosen.
Name-scrubbing	Automatically replacing any real name in teachers’ notes with a placeholder before sending for writing.
PDPA	Singapore’s Personal Data Protection Act, which governs how the school handles personal data.